

Personal Assistant robot can move around, recognise people and interact with IoT ecosystems. It's like a smartphone on wheels; except it has a face and voice recognition. It's proficient at things like waking you up, reminding you of things, dictating information, keeping track of health, giving status updates about its environment and people are present. Apart from these, the Personal Robot can be fed with a bunch of data, which it can analyse for you. Once it knows the database, you can ask it questions as if you would ask a normal person. This makes the robot a great choice for office environments too. Because of its ability to move and stay connected to the internet, you can use your smartphone and ask the robot to go around the house or workspace for you to keep a check on the area. Now obviously it's not like Jarvis, it's quite rough around the edges. Often it could take some time to understand what you say and well you can imagine what would happen if you leave the bot with a pet.

There's also a lot happening in DIY segment, especially the open source segment. BQ's Zowi is one such playful member of the DIY Robotics community. Zowi bots are easy to assemble and are mostly targeted towards students. But of course there's nothing stopping adults from indulging as well. After all who doesn't like 3D printing and modding?

RoboEve Xpider is another easy to grasp DIY kit. A little more complex than Zowi in terms of hardware. It comes with 26 different designs and 40 parts each. But it is powered by the software SmartNode which provides an easy drag and drop interface to program the robot.

Another kit with the complexity upped is the Poppy Humanoid. Don't expect to get done with a Poppy Humanoid over a single weekend. It's a great way for anyone who wants to enter the robotics industry professionally.

And finally, we have the InMoov. This guy has been around since 2012 when its arm became the first 3D printed open-source robotics project. InMoov is incredibly complex. You're basically given a space to create a human-like being. There are guidelines available, but the creator of this project expects its users to figure out what to do. Although it is recommended that you start with the arm if you do not have prior experience with creating programmed hardware.

Those that shall be

What if someone would fuse the utility of the Personal Assistant with the charm of Cozmo? Well, some people did just that. **Jibo** is a home assistant with skillsets very similar to the Personal Assistant. Although it doesn't